ACUPRESSURE & ACUPUNCTURE

COMPACT CANVAS NOTES — ACADEMIC STUDY GUIDE

ACUPRESSURE (ENERGY BALANCING)

Acupressure is a hands-on therapy that aims to restore balance (homeostasis) in:

- Energy flow
- Blood
- Lymph
- Hormones
- Nerve conduction

> العلاج بالضغط هو نوع من العلاج اليدوي هدفه إعادة التوازن داخل الجسم سواء في الطاقة أو الدم أو الجهاز الليمفاوي أو الهرمونات أو الإشارات العصبية.

PRINCIPLES OF ACUPRESSURE

PRINCIPLE	DESCRIPTION
1. Feeling	Therapist senses what is happening inside the patient during treatment.
2. Hands-on & Touch	Touch is a powerful therapeutic tool that induces relaxation.
3. Caring	Empathy and patient care are essential.
4. Non-invasive	No surgery or body penetration.
5. Rapport	Strong therapist-patient relationship improves outcomes.
6. Combination of Therapies	Can be combined with Reflexology, Touch Therapy & Shiatsu.

Treatment Methods

- Holding acupoints.
- Balancing Chi energy between points.

TCM MEASUREMENT (TRADITIONAL CHINESE MEDICINE)

Cun

- Unit used to locate acupoints.
- Based on patient's body.

> ***Rule:*** *1 cun = Width of patient's thumb*

🔹 MERIDIANS

Definition

Pathways carrying positive and negative energy through the body.

Functions

- Connect organs, tissues and body parts.
- Carry Chi energy.
- Nourish organs.

Acupuncture Points

- Located along meridians.
- Have unique electrical properties.

🔹 ACUPUNCTURE POINTS

Characteristics

- Small palpable spots.
- Electromagnetic properties.
- Detected manually or electrically.

Number

≈ 500 points used for:

- Diagnosis
- Treatment

🔹 WHAT IS CHI?

Definition: A subtle energy that is not electrical itself but produces measurable electrical effects.

🔹 CHI CONCEPT

> **Mind → Chi → Body**

Effects

- Connects body, mind & consciousness.
- Change in one affects the others.

FUNCTIONS OF CHI

Chi performs the following vital bodily functions:

- Holds organs and structures in place.
- Regulates body temperature.

Weak Chi Causes:

- Organ prolapse.
- Organ dysfunction.

SCIENTIFIC OBSERVATIONS OF CHI

Findings

Radioactive substances injected into acupoints:

- Moved along meridians.
- Travelled 30 cm in 4–6 min.
- Passed through tiny channels.

MIRACLES OF CHI

Meridian channels contain:

- DNA
- RNA
- Hormones
- Biochemical substances

ACUPUNCTURE POINT & HORMONES

Observation: High adrenaline levels found in acupoints.

Suggests: Link between meridians and the endocrine system.

CELLULAR ROLE

Meridian ducts exert genetic and structural control:

- Reach cell nuclei.
- Affect genetic control centers.
- Participate in cell replication.
- Participate in cell differentiation.

CHI & ELECTRICITY BALANCE

Chi Produces:

Induced electrical fields → DC current interactions.

Effects

- Affect bioelectronic processes.
- Maintain cellular coherence.
- Organize cellular structure.

Deficient Energy Causes:

- Cellular disruption.
- Disease.

THE MERIDIAN CYCLE

Classification: Yin & Yang

Characteristics: Connected deeply inside body. Clinical work mainly uses superficial portions.

Direction of Flow

Yang (Comes from Sun):

- Fingers → Face
- Face → Feet

Yin (Comes from Earth):

- Feet → Torso
- Inner Arm → Fingertips

> ***Important:*** *Energy flow is continuous, unbroken, circular, with no beginning or end.*

YIN & YANG

Concept: Opposite but complementary aspects of Chi.

Clinical Meaning

YANG	YIN
Acute	Chronic

Important Facts

- Yin exists inside Yang.
- Yang exists inside Yin.
- Complete Yin = Death.

🔹 ENERGY CONCEPT

YIN	YANG
Earth	Sun
Negative	Positive
Concentration	Movement
Stability	Dispersion

> ***Rule:*** *When one increases → the other decreases.*
> ***Essential:*** *Balance between Yin & Yang = Life.*

🔹 CLINICAL DIFFERENCE

YANG (ACUTE)	YIN (CHRONIC)
Pain	Dull pain
Inflammation	Stiffness
Heat	Sluggishness
Redness	Edema
Treatment: Sedation	**Treatment:** Stimulation

> ***Exam Rule:***
> ✓ *Sedate Yang*
> ✓ *Stimulate Yin*

YIN–YANG ORGAN PAIRS

YANG ORGAN (SUPERFICIAL)	YIN ORGAN (DEEP)
Small Intestine	Heart
Bladder	Kidney
Large Intestine	Lung
Gall Bladder	Liver
Stomach	Spleen
Triple Heater	Pericardium

THREE HEATER (TRIPLE WARMER)

Characteristics

- Yang meridian.
- Paired with Pericardium.

Course

Ring Finger → Hand → Forearm → Elbow → Shoulder

Location

Runs between: Radius and Ulna.

FIVE ELEMENTS THEORY

Five Elements: Fire, Earth, Metal, Water, Wood.

Important Structural Depth: Yang organs = Superficial | Yin organs = Deep

Cycles

1. Sheng (Creation) Cycle:

Fire → Earth → Metal → Water → Wood → Fire

- Fire → Earth (Ash)
- Earth → Metal
- Metal → Water
- Water → Wood
- Wood → Fire

2. Ko (Control) Cycle:

CONTROLLER	CONTROLLED
Water	Fire
Fire	Metal
Metal	Wood
Wood	Earth
Earth	Water

Purpose: Chi moves between elements to maintain balance.

ACUPUNCTURE PAIN MANAGEMENT

Core clinical focal areas include:

- Scientific basis of acupuncture.
- Mechanisms of pain management.
- Clinical trials & research.
- Pain evaluation methods.

NEUROHUMORAL APPROACH

> **Acupoint → Brain → Hormones → Organ**

Effect: Acupuncture stimulates the brain and nervous system, leading to chemical release, hormonal release, and organ regulation.

EFFECTS OF ACUPUNCTURE ON THE BRAIN

Assessment Tool: fMRI (Functional Magnetic Resonance Imaging)

Findings

ACUPOINT	EFFECT
LI4	Activates Visual Cortex
Tin Hui	Activates Auditory Cortex

Conclusion: Acupuncture directly affects brain activity.

🔹 GATE CONTROL THEORY

Proposed By: Melzack & Wall (1965)

Site: Substantia Gelatinosa of the spinal cord.

Mechanism: Dependent on the structural balance between excitatory fibers and inhibitory fibers.

Effect: Blocks pain transmission temporarily.

Limitation: Does not explain long-term therapeutic effects.

🔹 ENDORPHIN THEORY

Endorphins: Natural morphine-like substances.

Acupuncture Causes Release Of: Endorphins, Corticoids, and Substance P.

Result: Strong, sustained pain reduction.

🔹 MECHANISMS OF ACTION

1. Electromagnetic signal conduction.
2. Opioid system activation.
3. Brain chemistry changes.
4. Neurotransmitter changes.
5. Hormonal changes.

🔹 IMPORTANT ACUPOINTS

LI4 — "Joining the Valley"

- **Uses:** Headache, Toothache, Neck pain, Shoulder pain.
- **Location:** Between thumb and index finger.
- **Method:** Press for several minutes.
- ❌ **Contraindication: Pregnancy**

P6 — Pericardium Point

- **Uses:** Nausea, Vomiting, Motion sickness, Post-operative nausea.
- **Location:** 3 fingers below wrist between tendons.

Third Eye (GV 24.5)

- **Uses:** Stress, Insomnia, Headache.
- **Location:** Between eyebrows.
- **Effect:** Calming, mental clarity.

B54 — Knee/Back Point

- **Uses:** Back pain, Arthritis, Sciatica.
- **Location:** Behind the knee.
- **Evidence:** May be more effective than physiotherapy in some clinical cases.

🔹 THERAPEUTIC MECHANISMS (KENDALL, 1980)

1. Needle insertion → inflammatory response.
2. Pain signals → dorsal horn.
3. Activation of gamma loop & crossover neurons.
4. Activation of somatic motor nerves.
5. Activation of autonomic nerves.

🔥 EXAM HIGH-YIELD SUMMARY

Definitions

- **Chi:** Energy regulating body electrically & cellularly.
- **Meridians:** Energy pathways.
- **Acupoints:** Energy control points.

Yin vs Yang

- Yang = Acute | Yin = Chronic.
- Sedate Yang.
- Stimulate Yin.

Pain Relief

- **Gate Control:** Short-term pain relief.
- **Endorphin Theory:** Long-term pain relief.

Brain Effects

- Proven scientifically by fMRI.

Neurohumoral Pathway

Acupoint → Brain → Hormones → Organ

Important Acupoints

- **LI4:** Headache / Toothache / Neck & Shoulder Pain ❌ **Pregnancy**
- **P6:** Nausea & Vomiting
- **Third Eye (GV24.5):** Stress & Insomnia
- **B54:** Back Pain / Arthritis / Sciatica

Important Numbers / Meta Data

- **1 Cun:** Thumb Width
- **≈ 500:** Acupoints

- **30 cm in 4–6 min:** Speed of substance movement
- **Melzack & Wall:** 1965
- **Kendall:** 1980